

Marwadi (Marwari), Step by Step, Sign by Sign

A gentle writing-first curriculum, one usable greeting at a time

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Starter edition — sixteen lessons, each no longer than five minutes.

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How to use this starter edition

Begin with no assumed Marwadi and no assumed Devanagari. Each section lasts at most five minutes. The first section gives the hand one sign to copy; later sections move through guided copy, delayed copy, and independent recall. The writing ramp never waits for an alphabet chapter and never asks for a sign that has not already been isolated.

The name in the title is deliberately double. Official and linguistic sources often use *Marwari*; many speakers and learners use *Marwadi*. This book uses Marwadi as its short name and keeps Marwari visible for discoverability.

Chapter 1 makes one narrow promise: you will be able to read, say, and write the respectful greeting राम-राम सा, and answer it. Chapter 2 adds one formal gratitude response, आभार, through two new signs. Chapter 3 isolates two more signs before adding respectful affirmative हां सा. These are real pre-A1 steps, not a claim that the level is complete.

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Chapter 1

Ram-Ram Sa: A Greeting the Hand Can Make

Modes:  voice (2)  pen (5)  Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, read, say, copy, and write the respectful Marwadi greeting राम-राम सा, and answer it with the same greeting.

A two-line authentic greeting exchange followed by independent written recall, using only signs and language taught in the chapter.

1.1 र — one sign, and the beginning of a greeting

You do not need an alphabet first. Today your eye and hand need one sign.

Script — notice the sign

र — *ra*

Devanagari consonants carry a short *a* by default, so this is **ra**, not a bare *r*. The *r* is a quick tongue-tip tap.

Writing — guided copy

Put a finger over र and follow the printed shape. Then copy it three times, large and slow. Say *ra* each time your pen stops.

This lesson asks you to copy the shape you can see. It does not invent one universal stroke order where school traditions differ.

Before you move on

Cover the model. Point to the one you copied most clearly and say its sound.

1.2 ा — make *ra* into *rā*

Read र. (*ra*.) Copy it once.

Script — add one mark

The mark ा sits on the right of a consonant and lengthens its vowel:

र *ra* + ा *ā* = रा *rā*

Hold *ā* steady; do not turn it into English *ray*.

Writing — guided copy

- copy र
- add ा on its right
- read the result: रा *rā*

Do that three times. On the last copy, wait five seconds after looking at the model before you write.

Before you move on

Which is *ra*: र or रा? Which is *rā*?

1.3 म — your first whole written word

Write रा after looking away from the model. Check it, then begin.

Script — add म

म — *ma*

Join it to the piece you know:

रा $rā$ + म ma = राम $rām$

At the end of this word, the built-in vowel of म is not pronounced in ordinary speech. Read the whole word $rām$. राम is the name *Ram*. The Marwadi greeting you are building will repeat this name. Today you only need the one word राम; the complete greeting still comes later.

Writing — from copy to memory

1. copy म twice
2. copy राम once while looking
3. hide the model for ten seconds
4. write राम from memory, then compare

If the memory copy stalls, return only to the missing sign.

Before you move on

Read राम without using the romanization, say that it is the name *Ram*, then write it once more.

1.4 स — a second consonant

Read राम, say what it means, then write it from memory. Check that your last sign is म.

Script — notice and copy

स — sa

Like र, this consonant carries a short a . Do not confuse the two:

र ra · स sa

Finger-trace स, then copy it three times. Say sa as each copy finishes.

Before you move on

Cover the large model and write स once from the copy you remember.

1.5 सा — reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule

What did ा do to र? Apply the same change to स.

Script — assemble

स *sa* + ा *ā* = सा *sā*

The writing rule is old; only the combination is new. In the greeting you are building, सा is a respectful form of address.

Writing — delayed copy

Copy सा once. Look away for ten seconds, say *sā*, and write it again. Then retrieve the two known pieces separately rather than using them as a phrase before the next lesson teaches the greeting:

राम

>

सा

Before you move on

Read राम, then सा. Circle the copy of ा in each separate word.

1.6 राम-राम सा — your first complete Marwadi greeting

Read राम and सा separately. You already own every sign in to-day's line.

The exchange — meet the greeting

राम-राम सा। — *Rām-rām sā*. — a respectful greeting

Repeat राम, then add respectful सा. Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot* prints this exchange:

A: राम-राम सा।

>

B: राम-राम सा, राम-राम।

That attestation is why this track begins here rather than substituting a Hindi greeting merely because the scripts are shared.

Your turn — use and write it

- *Hear:* *rām-rām sā* [YOU ANSWER: राम-राम सा]
- *Read it:* राम-राम सा [YOU SAY: the line without romanization]
- *Copy:* राम-राम सा once, keeping the hyphen and space

Before you move on

Hide the line. Say the greeting once; then write as much as you can remember.

Source: Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, August–September 2018.

1.7 Practice — hear it, answer it, write it

With the page covered, write राम and सा separately. Check only after both are down.

The exchange

A: राम-राम सा।

>

B: राम-राम सा, राम-राम।

Run both voices once. Then cover B and answer A aloud. Switch roles.

Your turn — four-skill checkpoint

1. **Listen:** ask someone or a screen reader to say *rām-rām sā* without showing the text; identify it as a greeting. 2. **Speak:** give the greeting without reading. 3. **Read:** read राम-राम सा without romanization. 4. **Write:** close the book for fifteen seconds, then write राम-राम सा from memory. Check the repeated word, hyphen, space, and final सा.

Writing counts only if the model was hidden. Copying was the ramp; this is recall.

Before you move on

If one sign stalled, mark that sign and repeat only its short lesson tomorrow.

Chapter 2

Aabhaar: Formal Thanks, Two New Signs

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, hear, say, copy, and independently write आभार as a short formal gratitude response.

A source-attested formal gratitude word built from two new signs and two signs already taught, followed by independent four-skill retrieval.

2.1 आ — long ā at the beginning

With the page covered, write राम and give the greeting reply you learnt in Chapter 1. Uncover. Point to the vowel mark in रा: you know ी when long ā follows a consonant.

Script — one new sign

When long ā begins a word, it stands by itself:

आ — ā

Notice the upright line at the right. Say one steady ā while your finger follows the sign.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at आ for three seconds
2. finger-trace it once
3. copy it twice
4. compare only the upright line and the top bar

Do not add a word yet. This session belongs to one sign.

Before you move on

Cover the models. Write आ once, then uncover and compare.

2.2 भ — *bha*, with a small breath

Write स, then आ, from memory. Check both before moving on.

Script — one new sign and sound

भ — *bha*

Begin like English *b*, then let a small puff of air follow. Hold a hand near your mouth: *bha*. The breath is part of the sound.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at भ
2. finger-trace its lower shape, then the upright line
3. copy भ twice
4. say *bha* after each copy

Stop there. The next lesson will join this sign to signs already in your hand.

Before you move on

Cover the model for five seconds. Write भ, uncover, and compare.

2.3 आभार — formal thanks, built from known signs

Write सा from memory. Then read these four pieces: आ • भ • ा • र.

Script — build the word

Join only signs you already know:

आ + भ + ा + र = आभार

>

ābhār — formal thanks; gratitude

Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot* uses आभार when expressing gratitude in Rajasthani prose. It is a formal, Sanskrit-derived word. This lesson keeps that register visible rather than pretending every kind of thanks sounds the same.

Writing — from guided to delayed copy

1. copy आभार once while looking
2. point to भा and say *bhā*
3. hide the word for ten seconds
4. write आभार from memory
5. compare one sign at a time

If one sign stalls, practise only that sign before trying the word again.

Before you move on

Read आभार, say its meaning, then write it once with the model covered.

Source: Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, April 2004.

2.4 Practice — receive a kindness, offer formal thanks

Give the respectful Chapter 1 greeting from memory. Then, with the new word covered, write आ, then भ. Uncover and check.

The exchange — one courtesy move

Someone helps you or gives you something. Offer formal thanks:

आभार। — *Ābhār*. — Thank you. / My gratitude.

Use it here as a complete short response. A later chapter can add a more casual Marwadi gratitude form; do not make this one word carry every register.

Your turn — four tiny skills

1. **Listen:** ask someone or a screen reader to say *ābhār*; identify it as formal gratitude.
2. **Speak:** imagine receiving help and say आभार without reading.
3. **Read:** choose the thanks word from राम · आभार · सा.
4. **Write:** close the book for fifteen seconds, then write आभार from memory.

The written response counts only with the model hidden.

Before you move on

If आ or भ stalled, return to that sign's two-minute practice before repeating the whole word.

Chapter 3

Haan Sa: A Respectful Yes, Sign by Sign

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, hear, say, copy, and independently write हाँ सा as a respectful affirmative answer.

A source-attested polite affirmative built from two tiny script steps and the already-known respect word सा, followed by independently scored four-skill retrieval.

3.1 ह — *ha*, one new sign

Give the Chapter 1 greeting reply from memory. Then, with आभार covered, say it as formal thanks and write it once. Uncover only long enough to check each sign.

Script — one sign and one sound

ह — *ha*

Let the air pass freely as you say *ha*. Do not add the rest of the coming word yet; today the eye, ear, voice, and hand meet only ह.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at ह for three seconds
2. finger-trace its lower curve and upright line
3. copy ह twice
4. say *ha* after each copy

Before you move on

Cover the model for five seconds. Write ह, uncover, and compare.

3.2 ः — a small dot for the nasal ending

Write ह, then भ, from memory. Add the familiar long-ā mark to ह: हा. Read it once.

Script — one small new mark

ँ — a dot above

In the source spelling हँ, this dot cues the nasal ending. Say *hā(n)* slowly: the vowel is long and the ending resonates through the nose. Speakers vary, so listen for the whole word rather than forcing one exaggerated sound.

Writing — add only the mark

1. copy हा once 2. look at हँ 3. add ँ above the end of your copy 4. compare the dot's position, then say *hā(n)*

Before you move on

Hide हँ for five seconds. Write it once, then uncover and compare.

3.3 हां सा — a respectful yes

Say the Chapter 1 greeting from memory. Write हां, then सा, as two separate known pieces.

The exchange — join the two pieces

हां सा। — *Hā(n) sā.* — Yes, respectfully.

The first word answers yes. Familiar सा keeps the answer respectful. A scholarly Marwari text edition identifies *hā(n)-sā* as the polite affirmative, and a Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi dialogue writes हां सा in context.

Writing — guided, then delayed

1. copy हां सा once while looking
2. point to the space between the answer and the respect word
3. hide the phrase for ten seconds
4. write हां सा from memory
5. compare हां, the space, and सा separately

Before you move on

Say हां सा once without looking, then write it once with the model covered.

Sources: Hess, *Texts and Translations* and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, April–May 2019.

3.4 Listen and answer — yes without the page

Write the first sign of आभार, then the first sign of हां सा. Say which belongs to formal thanks and which begins a yes answer.

You'll want to know: answer by ear

Have someone or a screen reader say these in either order: *ābhār* and *hā(n)sā*. Without looking, point left for formal thanks and right for respectful yes. Then say हां सा as the answer to a question you accept.

Your turn — four tiny skills

1. **Listen:** identify *hā(n)sā* without seeing it.
2. **Speak:** answer yes respectfully without reading.
3. **Read:** choose हां सा from आभार · हां सा · राम.
4. **Write:** cover all models and write only हां.

Before you move on

Close the page. Say हां सा, then write हां from memory.

3.5 Practice — hear a yes, give a yes

With the page covered, write भ, then हां. Say आभार for formal thanks; say हां सा for a respectful yes.

Your turn — independent four-skill check

1. **Listen:** hear $hā(n) sā$ and identify an affirmative answer, without text.
2. **Speak:** hear “Will you come?” and answer yes respectfully, without notes.
3. **Read:** cover the English and explain **हां सा**.
4. **Write:** hear $hā(n) sā$, wait fifteen seconds, then write the complete phrase.

Score each line separately. A missed line is the one to repeat; three stronger skills do not erase a writing or listening miss.

What you’ve built — and what remains

You can now give one respectful affirmative. You have not yet learnt the Marwadi responses for no or okay, and you have not completed a yes/no exchange. Those remain separate tiny steps.

Before you move on

If the dot or **ह** stalled, return only to its two-minute sign lesson before trying the complete dictation again.

Pronunciation & Writing Reference

This is a lookup page, never a prerequisite gate.

The sounds in Chapter 1

- **r** in *rām* is a brief tongue-tip tap, not the English bunched or retroflex *r*. Say a quick Spanish-style single *r* if that is familiar.
- **ā** is a steady open vowel held longer than short *a*. The macron in transliteration marks length; Devanagari writes it with ा after a consonant.
- **m** and **s** are close to English *m* and *s*.

The writing rule you need first

Devanagari consonants carry a built-in short *a*. Thus र is *ra* and स is *sa*. The right-side mark ा changes that vowel to long *ā*: रा *rā*, सा *sā*. The chapter teaches only those signs and combines them as राम-राम सा.

The lessons ask learners to copy visible forms before they claim a stroke order. Handwriting conventions vary across schools, so a directional stroke sequence will be added only with a specific source. For Marwari-specific Devanagari history and characters, see the Unicode proposal on Devanagari letters for Marwari.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

आभार *ābhār*

formal thanks; gratitude

Introduced in Chapter 2.

हां सा *hā(n) sā*

yes, respectfully

Introduced in Chapter 3.

राम *rām*

Ram, the name repeated in the greeting **राम-राम सा**, built and written from र + ा + म

Introduced in Chapter 1.

राम-राम सा *rām-rām sā*

a respectful Marwadi greeting

Introduced in Chapter 1.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 र — *one sign, and the beginning of a greeting*

What sound does र carry?

1.2 ा — *make ra into rā*

What does ा do to the built-in vowel of a consonant?

1.3 राम — *your first whole written word*

Build and name the written word rām from its three visible pieces.

1.4 स — *a second consonant*

Which sign is sa: र or स?

1.5 सा — *reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule*

Write sā by adding the long-vowel mark to स.

1.6 राम-राम सा — *your first complete Marwadi greeting*

Give the respectful Marwadi greeting taught in this lesson.

1.7 Practice — *hear it, answer it, write it*

You hear rām-rām sā. Write the respectful reply from memory.

Chapter 2

2.1 आ — *long ā at the beginning*

Which sign writes long ā at the beginning of a word?

2.2 भ — *bha, with a small breath*

Read the new sign भ and name its sound.

2.3 आभार — *formal thanks, built from known signs*

Build the formal Marwadi/Rajasthani word for thanks from आ + भ + ा + र.

2.4 Practice — *receive a kindness, offer formal thanks*

You receive formal help. Write the one-word thanks response from memory.

Chapter 3

3.1 ह — *ha, one new sign*

Read the one new sign ह and name its sound.

3.2 ः — *a small dot for the nasal ending*

Which small mark completes the attested spelling हं?

3.3 हां सा — *a respectful yes*

Write the respectful Marwadi yes from ह + ा + ः, followed by the respect word सा.

3.4 Listen and answer — *yes without the page*

You hear hā(n) sā. What social move did the speaker make?

3.5 Practice — *hear a yes, give a yes*

From the spoken cue hā(n) sā alone, write the respectful affirmative.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 र — *one sign, and the beginning of a greeting*

Answer: रा

Also accepted: र a; र

1.2 ा — *make ra into rā*

Answer: It changes short a to long ā.

Also accepted: makes it aa; lengthens a; long a

1.3 राम — *your first whole written word*

Answer: राम — Ram

Also accepted: राम; र + ा + म; रा + म

1.4 स — *a second consonant*

Answer: स

Also accepted: the second sign; sa is स

1.5 सा — *reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule*

Answer: सा

Also accepted: स + ा; saa

1.6 राम-राम सा — *your first complete Marwadi greeting*

Answer: राम-राम सा

Also accepted: राम राम सा; rām-rām sā; ram-ram sa

1.7 Practice — *hear it, answer it, write it*

Answer: राम-राम सा

Also accepted: राम राम सा; rām-rām sā; ram-ram sa

Chapter 2

2.1 आ — *long ā at the beginning*

Answer: आ

Also accepted: aa independent; independent aa

2.2 भ — bha, *with a small breath*

Answer: bha

Also accepted: भ

2.3 आभार — *formal thanks, built from known signs*

Answer: आभार — formal thanks

Also accepted: आभार; aabhaar; ābhār

2.4 Practice — *receive a kindness, offer formal thanks*

Answer: आभार

Also accepted: ābhār; aabhaar

Chapter 3

3.1 ह — ha, *one new sign*

Answer: ha

Also accepted: ह

3.2 ः — *a small dot for the nasal ending*

Answer: ः

Also accepted: anusvara; dot above; nasal mark

3.3 हाँ सा — *a respectful yes*

Answer: हाँ सा

Also accepted: हाँ सा!; haan sa; hā(n) sā

3.4 Listen and answer — *yes without the page*

Answer: They answered yes respectfully.

Also accepted: respectful yes; yes politely; yes

3.5 Practice — *hear a yes, give a yes*

Answer: हाँ सा

Also accepted: हाँ सा!; haan sa; hā(n) sā

Sources for this starter edition

The opening exchange is attested in Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot*, August–September 2018. Its April 2004 issue uses आभार while expressing gratitude in Rajasthani prose. Rajasthan Foundation's official language page places Marwari among the major forms of Rajasthani. The lesson files carry the direct links. Chapters 1 and 2 are generated from those canonical files. Chapter 3 adds a scholarly Marwari text edition that identifies *hā(n)-sā* as the polite affirmative and an April–May 2019 *Jāgtī Jot* dialogue that uses हाँ सा in context.

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

A

a respectful Marwadi greeting राम-राम सा (rām-rām sā)

Chapter 1, p. 1

◌ं — **a small dot for the nasal ending**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 11

Aabhaar: Formal Thanks, Two New Signs

chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 7

F

formal thanks; gratitude आभार (ābhār)

explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 7

H

Haan Sa: A Respectful Yes, Sign by Sign

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 11

M

◌ी — **make *ra* into *rā***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

R

Ram-Ram Sa: A Greeting the Hand Can Make

chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

Ram, the name repeated in the greeting राम-राम सा, built and written from र + ा + म राम (rām)

explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

Y

yes, respectfully हाँ सा (hā(n) sā)

explicit focus: writing; Chapter 3, p. 11

Other

आ — long ā at the beginning

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 7

भ — bha, with a small breath

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 7

र — one sign, and the beginning of a greeting

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

स — a second consonant

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

सा — reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ह — ha, one new sign

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 11